

Promotion is a choice

Foundations

THE IDEA

A pawn reaching the last rank must become a queen, rook, bishop, or knight of its own color. Promotion is part of that move. A queen is usually strongest, but a knight can give a unique check or fork, and a smaller piece can sometimes avoid stalemate.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A pawn on c7 that advances to c8 may promote even if its original queen remains on the board. There is no rule limiting a side to one queen. The position determines which promotion works best.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why should you inspect knight promotion before automatically choosing a queen?

ANSWER AND REASONING

A knight attacks squares a queen does not from the same square. A checking promotion can gain a decisive tempo. Also compare stalemate and the opponent's immediate threats.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Promotion deserves calculation, not autopilot.